



Chelsey Harris | [umpmarketing@umpress.umass.edu](mailto:umpmarketing@umpress.umass.edu)

## FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

### **Founder of Old Ladies Against Underwater Garbage reveals how she got her start in Cape Cod ponds in new memoir**

**CAPE COD, MA**—When Susan Baur told the story of what inspired her to create the underwater cleanup group Old Ladies Against Underwater Garbage (OLAUG), Drew Barrymore [burst into tears](#).

Since its founding in 2017, OLAUG's work has drawn national attention. A documentary on OLAUG premiered at the 5Point Film Festival in Carbondale, Colorado in April. This summer, Baur and her organization are scheduled to appear in the *New York Times*, the *Boston Globe*, on the *Daily Show*, and on the BBC.

In her new memoir coming this September from the University of Massachusetts Press, Susan Baur discusses the inspiration for the founding of this beloved environmental group—and much more.

The memoir, *Swimming with Turtles: How Wonder Reconnects Us to the Natural World*, reveals how slowing down to explore the ponds of Cape Cod brought Baur joy, companionship, and solace after the death of the man she loved. Baur recorded her daily swims for over two decades and “was tracing what actually happens when wonder launches any one of us on an irresistible journey,” as she writes in the book's prologue.

Sy Montgomery, bestselling author of *Of Time and Turtles: Mending the World, Shell by Shattered Shell*, calls the book “a wonder and a revelation.”

The practice of slowing down and noticing what others miss, which is the foundation of OLAUG, is the same practice that guides *Swimming with Turtles*. With humor, heart, and vivid observation, Baur shows that wonder isn't reserved for the young or the lucky—it waits beneath the surface for anyone willing to slow down, look closely, and stay a while.

“*Swimming with Turtles* inspires. It left me buzzing with the desire to get outside and immerse myself in the world,” says Kai Potter, author of *Noticing: The Quiet Season on Outer Cape Cod*. “It's filled with insights and nuggets of wisdom so valuable that I found myself writing them down as I read.”

To request a review copy or an interview with the author, please contact Chelsey Harris, University of Massachusetts Press Marketing and Sales Director, at [umpmarketing@umpress.umass.edu](mailto:umpmarketing@umpress.umass.edu).

###